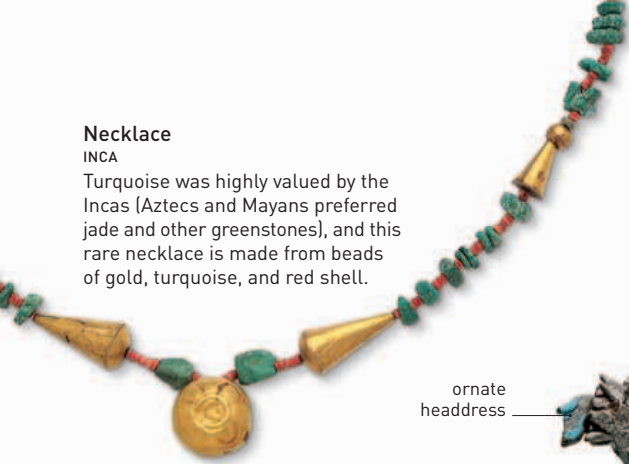


Necklace
INCA

Turquoise was highly valued by the Incas (Aztecs and Mayans preferred jade and other greenstones), and this rare necklace is made from beads of gold, turquoise, and red shell.



ornate
headdress

hunter disguised
as deer

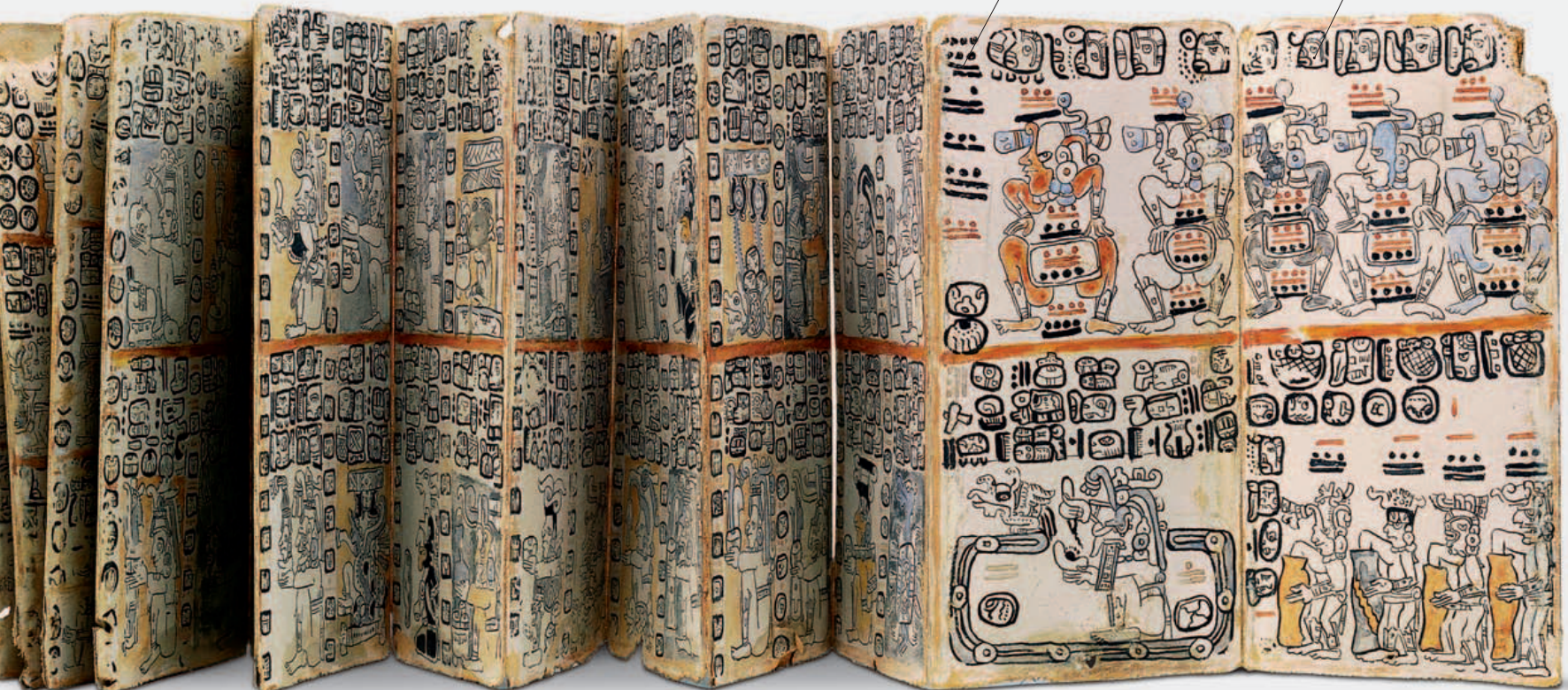


Decorative plate
MAYA

This plate from the Yucatán Maya shows hunting scenes—in the center, a hunter drapes a deer he has caught across his head and shoulders, while around the edges other hunters wear deer masks.

Codex Tro-Cortesianus
MAYA

One of only four surviving Mayan codices, this one records instructions for divination (predicting the future) and priestly rituals. Sheets of bark paper were coated in gesso (chalky paste) to form a writing surface.



Jaina figurine
MAYA

This pottery figure from the island of Jaina shows a powerful man dressed in all his finery, with a heavy bead necklace, massive headdress, and ear plugs.

heavy
earplugs



Tomb figurine
INCA

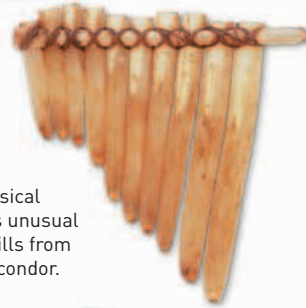
This cast gold figurine representing an Inca god made up part of the grave goods interred in the tomb of a high-status individual.

size and position of
knots records numbers



Panpipes
INCA

Known in Europe as the syrinx, the panpipes were among the most common Inca musical instruments. This unusual set is made of quills from the feathers of a condor.



elaborate
carvings

Greenstone yoke
MAYA

Yokes were worn as protective belts in the sacred ball game *ulama*, played by most Mesoamerican cultures. This ornate yoke was probably a ceremonial replica.

Counting device
INCA

This *quipu*, or counting device, was a versatile accounting tool that helped the Incas keep track of the tribute and population of their empire—data was recorded in lengths of string and knots.

bars and dots
represent numbers

codex was read
from top to bottom,
then left to right